

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

GPS

GPS stands for Global Positioning System. People mainly use it in their cars for navigation—the GPS satellite system can pinpoint where you are on the globe. The system was initially designed for, and is operated by, the US military. To pretend you know all about the system, say all the following without batting an eyelid.

☒ “It’s all about satellites and offsets, you know! Four satellite signals compute your position in three dimensions and the time offset in the receiver clock.”

☒ “GPS is everywhere! Soon you will have GPS built into your smartphone and, you know, you’ll know whether I am in my bathroom or in my bedroom.” (This is not realistic, but remember you are bluffing!)

☒ “It’s a wonderful thought, all those satellites out there monitoring where I am. The GPS Operational Constellation has 24 satellites orbiting Earth every 12 hours. The orbit altitude of those satellites is crazy! And with all those orbital planes equally spaced—60 degrees apart... in fact, they’re inclined at about 55 degrees with respect to the equatorial plane.” (You’re got to speak fast when you’re saying this. Make sure you say the keywords—“orbital planes” and so on—loudly.)

☒ When someone asks you how it’s all controlled, say with a wave of the hand, “It’s all from Colorado. The Schriever Air Force Base is where it’s at.”

☒ Now if someone gets inquisitive and asks how it all works, you’ll need a good memory. Memorise the following: “Position is determined from multiple pseudo-range measurements at a single measurement epoch. The pseudo-range measurements are used together with SV position estimates based on the ephemeris data each SV sends. That’s how they figure out where you are.”

Simple, eh?

Party Time!

You know how it is—life passes you by and you don’t even realise it. Then one day, you find out that you just did not have fun. And by then, it is too late.

At Digit, we would hate it if that were to happen. So, we have an annual jig called the Diwali party, where everyone (and we mean *everyone*) and their dear ones come to Jasubhai Digital Media’s headquarters in Navi Mumbai, and have the blast of a lifetime.

This time was no different. Kabir “the only guy who uses the gym” Malkani, and Digit’s Sachin “one of the remaining 199 guys who don’t use the gym” Kalbag were given the responsibility of organising the party.

Elizabeth, Bela, Riticha, Shailesh, Papiha, Nagesh, the Events telecalling team, Garfield, Ronak, Nilanjan, Chetan,

Pratap Singh, Aanand, Vijay, Ashwin, Rohini, Shyam, Viren, Ambarish, Kruttika, Deepika, Robert, and the list goes on—just about everyone pitched in to make it a grand success. People sang, people danced, jugglers ate swords, clowns danced, skeletons scared people, Scooby-Do, Popeye, and Noddy enthralled the kids, and expectedly, the audience clapped.

The team from Indian Architect and Builder then

had the most heartwarming event of the day—one candle was lit, and flame was then passed on to every single Jasubhai group team member to signify the commitment, the unity and the passion that each individual possesses.

Elizabeth says she has already begun practising for the next year’s party. Until reports last came in, others were about to follow.

DIGIT DIARY

stick. Then there was the bow and arrow, black powder, smokeless power and optics. Maybe this is the next technological step out there.”



One impediment, though, is that not everyone has the kind of broadband required for the virtual shooting to happen. So, Underwood’s cashing in on his scheme, as well as the fate of several species of wildlife, now depends on the widespread deployment of ADSL.

2.5 BILLION PIXELS IN A PIC

World’s Largest Digi-pic!

The Netherlands Organisation for Applied Scientific Research

claims to have produced the largest digital panoramic photo in the world. At 2.5 billion pixels, the picture is 500 times larger than what a modern five-megapixel consumer-grade camera can produce.

Shot from the top of the Electrical Engineering faculty of Delft University, at a height of about 100 metres, using an ordinary Nikon D1x and a 400 mm lens, the photograph shows the town of Delft and its surroundings in the autumn of 2004. If this photo were to be printed, the photographers say, it would measure 6.67 m by 2.67 m at 300 dpi.

MS STOLE YOGA GAME

Pulp Fiction Writer Sues Microsoft

Roger Avary, who won an Oscar for writing *Pulp Fiction* with Quentin Tarantino, is suing the software giant alleging it stole his idea for a yoga game. Avary claims Microsoft used his ideas in a Yoga game for the Xbox designed with ResponDesign called

Yoursell!Fitness.

Avary, who offers consultantancy services to games makers, claims he had a series of meetings with Microsoft in late 2002 and 2003 to attract more young women to playing games on the Xbox. Avary outlined his idea for a yoga game to them. He handed over notes but heard nothing back until he was asked to sign away his rights to the idea. He claims Microsoft executives loved his idea for a yoga workout game and described it as “the next killer app for Xbox.”

Ted Spooner, chief executive at ResponDesign, discounts Avary’s claim, and says that the idea was a wholly original creation of his company and made before Avary met Microsoft.

FIRE AT KENNEDY’S MOTORCADE

JFK’s Family Condemns Murder Game

A new computer game, *JFK: Reloaded*, in which players assume the role of